



the maximum performance out of it on an old system or boost your productivity on a fast system. Here are a few performance enhancements which will help speed things up:

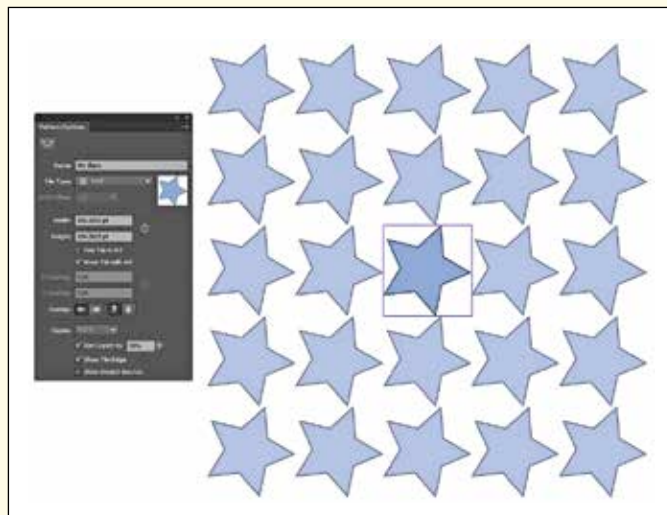
- **Watch the Efficiency Indicator** – You'll find the "Efficiency" indicator at the bottom of your Photoshop window, if it falls under 100% it means that you are using the hard drive for memory and Photoshop becomes slower
- **Close Unused Document Windows** – Like Windows having many unused documents takes up memory. Close any unused document that you may have opened
- **Purge History & Clipboard** – Photoshop's History feature is quite useful but it hogs a lot of memory. If you're not using it, purge the history by going to Edit > Purge > All
- **Set drawing mode to Basic** – Preferences > Performance > Graphics Processor Settings > Advanced Settings > Drawing Mode > Basic
- **Turn off Animated Zoom** – Preferences > General > Animated Zoom > Uncheck
- **Turn off Flick Panning** – Preferences > General > Enabled Flick Panning > Uncheck
- **Adjust Photoshop's Memory Use** – This has to be handled tactfully, you can get away with something as low as 40% but this is entirely subjective and instead of plugging in arbitrary values it's best to adjust this based on your physical memory capacity and individual need. You can do this by going to Preferences > Performance > Memory Usage
- **Disable anti-aliasing on guides and paths** – Preferences > Performance > Graphics Processor

Settings > Advanced Settings > Anti-alias Guides and Paths > Uncheck

- **Use less Video RAM** – Preferences > 3D > Available VRAM for 3D > 30%, this is particularly useful for anyone using a computer with a video card that shares VRAM with primary RAM
- **Turn off Image Previews** – This may seem a bit harsh but if you're really hard-pressed for memory than you should do this. Change Preferences > File Handling > File Saving Options > Image Previews > Never Save
- **Set Cache Levels to 1** – Note: This change impacts effect plugins and effect quality so use it with caution. The default value is 4 for a reason. Change the cache level by going to Preferences > Performance > History & Cache > Cache Levels > 1

ILLUSTRATOR

Illustrator has been the mainstay of graphic artists for a long time. Illustrator CS6 features a completely revamped rendering and tracing engine along with many other finer improvements suggested by users.



Pattern Creation in Action



Pattern Creation

Previously exercises in pattern generation would end with frayed nerves and frustration, it was an endeavor undertaken only by the most patient. The new Pattern Creation panel takes away all the complexity involved in creating seamless patterns. Creating a new pattern is as simple as selecting the object(s) that you want to include in a pattern and then navigating to Object > Pattern > Make.

A dialog box will pop up – it tells you that a new pattern has been added to your Swatches panel. Hit Ok and you'll see the pattern repeating itself in a simple grid. You can tweak the pattern add or remove shapes/object, specify the overlap mode, change the grid type and so on. Applying the pattern is as simple as selecting the Pattern swatch for Fill. You can go back and edit the pattern in the Pattern editing mode by double-clicking on the Pattern swatch.



Image Tracing

Illustrator CS6 brings to the fore a completely revamped tracing engine. The new tracing engine albeit good,



New and improved Image Tracing

works well with photos and allows quick and exact vector silhouettes but the presets don't work well when you want to trace sketches or textures in fact the Live Trace feature in Adobe Illustrator CS5 does slightly better compared to the one in the latest avatar when you use the presets.

A point to keep in mind is that we're talking about presets, and 99% of times the presets don't yield the exact result you want, you'll have to manually tweak the tracing settings to get the desired result. You can access the new tracing features from the Image Trace panel (Window > Image Trace).

You have an access to all other panels and tools which was not available in the previous version. Even the presets available have also changed for e.g. the new "Silhouettes" preset allows you to quickly create vector silhouettes.



Reset Workspace

How many times have you cluttered your workspace with myriad of panels, and then scratch your head when you can't find something. Illustrator CS6 provides an ability to reset the workspace to a default position by clicking on the "Reset <workspace>" option where <workspace> is